



XBMC

What is the point of having a fancy home theatre system with a vast collection of movies and video if you don't have the right software to support that hardware? It's like having a fancy PC and not installing an OS. This is where XBMC comes in. It is an open-source media centre system



specifically designed for home theatre systems. Featuring a 10 foot UI, screen size will never be an issue as far as legibility is concerned. Supporting a multitude of features including third-party plug-ins, easily editable code and a thriving open-source community, this media centre OS is the Android of the media centre world.



Klipsch audio

This venerable audio equipment manufacturer has been in operation since 1946. Their most famous speaker has to be the Klipschorn, or Khorn as it is better known. The speaker was patented in 1946 and now, more than 60 years down the line, the design is still their flagship loudspeaker set. Klipsch has always had a firm belief in horn loudspeakers and their designs mirror this. A company with a multitude of products ranging from IEMs to professional quality loudspeakers and PA systems, Klipsch is one of the old-time greats of the audio world.



HD

High-definition(HD) refers to a resolution higher than the traditional standard-definition resolution. There are three factors that define HD - the number of lines in the vertical display resolution, which is either 1080 or 720, the scanning system it uses - progressive or interlaced and third the number of frames persecond - progressive scans stands at 60Hz and interlaced at 50Hz. The newest term buzzing in the industry is 4K. 4k is essentially a resolution of 4096x2048 and is an emerging standard for resolution in the industry. In contrast to SD resolutions that are represented by number of vertical pixels 4K is represented by horizontal pixels. With the world rushing to buy HDTV's, one question still haunts us - Is there enough HD content? Sadly, there isn't! But with the help of upscalers like HD media players one can get HD-like quality by upscaling lesser resolution videos to HD.



Gerry O' Sullivan

The Director of Strategic Development of Sky TV, this man heralded the 3D TV revolution in the UK with the launch of the SKY HD 3DTV service. With the limited amount of 3D content currently available in the market, it is nice to have 3D content directly available on your TV set. Subscribers for the service were so many that the profits of SKY went up by over 4 per cent this year alone. A trend we hope to see in our country in the near future.



IPTV

IPTV as a technology is relatively new and still evolving. In simple terms, Internet TV or IPTV, is video and audio delivered over the Internet. With IPTV, you can stream programmes to your TV, mobile device or PC. What sets IPTV apart is the access to a wide variety of content as compared to a cable TV. Video on Demand (VoD) is



one of the killer features you get with IPTV. VOD is not just restricted to movies, and you can record TV programmes for later. However, IPTV has one huge drawback - it requires high bandwidth, and as we know, that's the one area India suffers. Even a slight dip in the bandwidth will result in a delay in the video and if the data is unreliable, you can expect more delays. But we hope that will change soon.



Zeppelin Air

This slim black coloured egg shaped dock speaker system from Bowers & Wilkins has one of the most unique form

factors, with the dock connector projecting above the speakers. The interesting part apart from design is its ability to play music over the air from your iPod, iPad or even your PC or Mac using your home network.



Electrostatic headphone

In production since 1959, these headphones are extremely expensive to make and require a high voltage source just to power them (440V). Traditional drivers use wire coils attached to diaphragms and a permanent magnet mounted behind. This whole cumbersome setup, not counting the permanent magnet, is what moves back and forth to produce audio. Electrostatic transducers use an incredibly fine diaphragm, one that is lighter than the air enclosed by the cups, placed between 2 plates. This diaphragm is then charged with electrons, a process which takes a minute or two, and the audio signal then creates an electrostatic field which pushes or pulls the electrons, which in-turn move the diaphragm to produce audio. The quality of the sound produced by such a system is extremely precise, with distortion levels that are 30 times lower than those of the best loudspeakers in the world! There is no damping required as there is no resonance, the diaphragm is so light that the surrounding air is sufficient as a damper.

150 db

The sound level, in decibels, at which your chest walls will start to vibrate, cause changes in your respiratory rhythm, and even cause a gag reflex. This is the sheer volume of noise that a space shuttle makes when taking off.